



**“Executives continue to stay intellectually engaged with emerging trends and technologies as a result of these interactions”**

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**“For students, it’s an amazing chance to hear real stories that connect what they learn in the class to how things work in the real world”**

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that modern management roles demand,” says Neti.

“Industry-led courses, case discussions, and live projects create opportunities for talent co-creation. Organisations gain early access to potential talent, while students receive first-hand feedback that aligns skills with industry expectations,” says Neti.

### THE PRACTITIONER INFLUENCE

The participation of industry leaders in classroom settings reflects a broader trend in management education worldwide. The traditional separation between “theorists who produce knowledge” and “practitioners who apply knowledge” is rapidly disappearing. “At Great Lakes Institute of Management, we involve business leaders in curriculum design, deliver practice-oriented courses, and ensure students engage in live projects with companies. This sustains relevance and strengthens our role in developing professionals who are prepared to lead in a rapidly changing business ecosystem.”

The benefits are quantifiable. Graduates of programmes developed with practitioner-led instruction show increased ability to solve applied problems and demonstrate leadership in the placement process. “Being taught by CXOs is obviously a bonus because you get to know real-life case studies sitting in your classrooms,” says Hema Senthil (name changed), who studied management in a B-school based out of Mumbai. Senthil, who works with one of the leading IT services companies in Bengaluru, says it was easier for their batch to get placed as prospective employers felt they were job-ready.

The trend also reflects the evolving business environment. Businesses in India face a transformation

of magnitude—digital disruption, climate, supply chain and shift in workforce expectations.

At TAPMI, too, the trend is structural. Kidiyoor says curriculum design now often includes joint teaching by faculty and industry executives. Advisory boards—primarily staffed by corporate leaders—update course content more frequently, ensuring alignment with rapidly evolving business realities. A notable shift is the rise of the “Professor of Practice” (POP) model. This permits industry professionals to take on full-time teaching roles without a PhD. “A 15-year work experience is good enough to teach in management institutions,” says Kidiyoor. Many institutions are also establishing centres of excellence in collaboration with industry, driving research on specialised domains. Companies, meanwhile, are increasingly offering skill-building certification courses, taught directly by industry professionals.

### MENTOR MOTIVATION

Why would India’s most active executives take time out to teach? Part of the answer lies in the desire to give back, says Neti of Great Lakes. “Executives view teaching as a means of contributing to the development of the next generation of leaders. They share with students their first-hand experiences, the challenges of ongoing businesses, and practical solutions that complement academic learning.”

There is another motivation: learning. “Executives continue to stay intellectually engaged with emerging trends and technologies as a result of these interactions,” says Neti of Great Lakes. For many CXOs, teaching provides a connection with the new thinking and talent pool that forces them to challenge their assumptions.